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Backlash about commentary

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Last week's Acorn published two commentaries on Senate Bill 14, authored by Sen. Shannon Grove (R-Bakersfield).

The differences in the commentaries are stark, with one offering facts from a currently seated elected official, and the second, a manufactured hit piece penned by John Andersen, the current chair of the Ventura County Republican Party, who is either ill-informed or simply has a loose association with facts.

There is no denying that after moving through the Senate with unanimous bipartisan support, SB 14 hit a wall when it came before the Assembly Public Safety Committee and was effectively killed.

The subsequent steps are where Mr. Andersen spins a tale and incorrectly points to local Assemblymembers Jacqui Irwin and Jesse Gabriel as roadblocks to moving the bill forward.

From his days on the Conejo Valley Unified School District board, Mr. Andersen should be able to remember how the rules of order work. Or perhaps he simply chose to put his completely fabricated partisan spin on the events to mislead people? I'm going with the latter.

Here's what actually happened. After predictable, well-warranted backlash, the Assembly Democratic leader brought forth a motion to refer SB 14 back to the Public Safety Committee for further consideration. Immediately after this motion was made, Republican Assemblymember Heath Flora raised a second motion that asked that the rules be suspended so the bill could be heard on the Assembly floor.

The rules of order that Mr. Andersen has apparently forgotten require that the motions be heard in order. The full Assembly then voted to send SB 14 back to the Public Safety Committee. This vote, which Assemblymember Irwin voted in favor of while Assemblymember Gabriel was excused from the session that day, rendered Assemblymember Flora's motion moot.

The Public Safety Committee met immediately thereafter and properly voted to move the bill forward.

Mr. Andersen states that neither Irwin nor Gabriel even cast a vote to bring the bill to the Assembly floor. The truth is that nobody else did either—there was no such vote. I'll leave it to you to decide for yourself why Mr. Andersen would intentionally mislead the public.

Facts matter, Mr. Andersen. Do better!

Joel Price

Thousand Oaks

Price, a former Thousand Oaks City Council member, is Assemblymember Jacqui Irwin's communications director.

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